

Demystifying **HTML 5 Attacks**

An attack vector is a path or means by which a hacker can get access to a website. HTML5 is rapidly emerging as the standard for rich Web applications—an alternative to proprietary applications like Silverlight and Flash. Unfortunately, it throws up security challenges in the form of attack vectors, which this article demystifies to a great extent.



HTML5 is redefining the future of Web applications by providing a rich set of new features along with extending the existing features and APIs of HTML4. HTML, the heart of the Web, has brought about significant advances with HTML5 by providing support for the latest multimedia and server communication. All the latest versions of browsers have support for HTML5.

HTML5 brings a whole slew of new features to Web browsers, some of which can be a threat to security and privacy. The new features include tags like `<button>`, `<video>`, `<footer>`, `<audio>` etc, and new attributes for tags such as *autocomplete* and *autofocus*. It also includes some additional features like local storage, cross origin resource sharing, etc. Even though all these features are an added benefit for Web developers, each of them can also be easily exploited.

Client-side or local storage: A secure feature?

Local storage is one of the prime features of HTML5. The main advantage is that you can make the HTML applications run while you are not connected to the network and possibly sync the data when you go online again. This improves the flexibility of the app. It's also a performance booster as you can show large amounts of data as soon as the user clicks on to your site, instead of waiting for it to download again. In other words, local storage has many advantages that help you to simplify tasks and also improve the performance. With a single line of code, you can add and retrieve information from local storage as follows:

```
localStorage.setItem(key, value);  
localStorage.getItem(key);
```